



5 The tea is immediately poured into the fairness cup, then into the nosing and tasting cups to keep them warm. It is then poured over the tea pet (see inset), for good luck. This first steep is considered a rinse infusion and is used to further warm the vessels, before it is discarded.



6 The tea leaves will begin to open. For the first infusion after the rinse, hot water is poured into and onto the teapot, until it overflows. The lid is replaced, as before, and hot water is poured over to clean and warm the pot. The tea is left to infuse for at least 10 seconds.



7 Tongs are then used to empty the tasting and nosing cups of the rinse infusion. The tea in the fairness cup is poured into the waste water bowl.



8 The underside of the teapot is dried with a soft cloth, and the tea is poured into the fairness cup through the tea strainer.



9 The tea is then poured from the fairness cup into the nosing cups, in a sweeping back and forth motion, until full, but not overflowing.